

Participant Information Sheet



THE UNIVERSITY
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AUSTRALIA

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Research title:	Supporting Passenger Decision-Making When Digital Public Transport Information Conflicts with Observed Conditions (Evaluating a Public Transport Decision Support App)
Lead researcher:	Yankun Yang, Student Researcher, The University of Queensland
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Thank you for your interest in participating in this research project. Please read the following information so that you can decide whether you would like to take part. Please feel free to ask any questions about your involvement. You may also talk to someone you trust, such as a family member or friend, before deciding whether to participate.

Participation in this research is voluntary. If you do not wish to take part, you do not have to. If you decide to take part and later change your mind, you are free to stop at any time, and you would not need to give any explanation for your decision to stop participating.

If you decide to take part, you will be asked to sign a Consent Form and will be given a copy of that signed form and this Participant Information Sheet to keep. Your decision whether you take part, or not to take part, or to take part and then withdraw, will not affect your relationship with The University of Queensland.

What is the purpose of this research?

This study evaluates a prototype public transport decision-support application designed for situations where digital journey information does not match what a passenger observes in the physical environment. The research aims to understand whether the prototype helps passengers recognise a disruption, understand its impact, compare alternative routes, and make a more confident travel decision. It also explores whether passengers would be willing to use this type of support and what additional functions would make it more useful. The project is being conducted as a student research and design project at The University of Queensland.

What does participation involve?

If you choose to participate, you will be asked to complete a short structured evaluation of the public transport prototype. You will be shown one or more simulated travel scenarios in which digital service information may conflict with observed conditions. You will use the prototype to identify the disruption, review suggested alternatives, and choose what you would do next. You may be asked to think aloud while completing the task, and you will then answer a short questionnaire and/or brief follow-up questions about clarity, usefulness, trust, willingness to use the app, and possible improvements. Participation is expected to take approximately 20–30 minutes and may take place on the UQ campus or remotely using the prototype. Participants must be 18 years or older. No audio or video recording is planned; the researcher may take written notes. The study does not access your real public transport account, travel history, payment information, or location data.

What are the possible benefits of taking part?

There will be no clear direct benefit to you from participating in this research. Your feedback may help the research team improve the design of public transport disruption information and decision-support features so that they are clearer and more actionable for passengers. No payment or reimbursement is offered for participation.

What are the possible risks and disadvantages of taking part?

This is a low-risk usability study. You may experience minor inconvenience, confusion, or frustration while working through simulated disruption scenarios or answering questions. You may skip any question or stop the activity at any time without giving a reason. A foreseeable risk is loss of privacy if responses were linked to your identity. To minimise this risk, research responses will be coded or de-identified, and signed consent forms will be stored separately from evaluation data. No real travel account credentials, payment details, or precise location information will be collected.

What will happen to the information about me?

By signing the Consent Form you consent to UQ collecting and using information as described in this Participant Information Sheet and the Consent Form. Information obtained in connection with this project will be retained and disposed of in accordance with relevant University of Queensland policies and applicable State and National requirements. For further information about research data management, you may refer to UQ's Research Data Management Policy. [Research Data Management Policy](#)

Any information obtained in connection with this research project that can identify you will remain confidential. Evaluation data will be assigned a participant code and, where possible, identifying details will be removed from research notes and questionnaire responses. Signed consent forms will be stored separately from the evaluation data. Access will be limited to the research team and authorised University staff where required for research governance or data management.

Results from this project may be included in university coursework, reports, presentations, demonstrations, or other academic outputs. Findings will be reported in an aggregated or de-identified form so that individual participants are not identified without their express permission.

Any information obtained during the research project is subject to inspection (for the purpose of verifying the procedures and the data) by the relevant authorities and authorised representatives of The University of Queensland, or as required by law. Designated University individuals (data stewards or custodians) may also have access to the information for the purposes of ensuring long term retention and disposal. By signing the Consent Form, you authorise release of, or access to, this confidential information to the relevant research personnel and authorities as noted above.

Personal Information

The personal information collected for this research project includes your name and signature on the Consent Form. The evaluation may also collect limited background information relevant to public transport use, such as how often you use public transport or journey-planning apps. You will not be asked to provide sensitive information.

Collection – Your personal information is collected to document informed consent and, where relevant, to help interpret usability feedback about the prototype.

Use – Your personal information will be used only for the purposes described in this Participant Information Sheet and the Consent Form. Research analysis will use coded or de-identified evaluation data wherever possible.

Storage and security – Personal information and signed consent forms will be stored securely and separately from coded evaluation data. Access will be limited to authorised members of the research team and authorised UQ staff where required for research data management.

Disclosure – Your personal information will not be disclosed to a third party without your agreement, except where required by law or University research governance requirements.

You have the right to request access to the personal information about you that is collected and stored by the research team. If you are seeking to update or correct any information, it is recommended that you liaise with the research team in the first instance (see contact details at the top of this information sheet).

You are also able to request amendment via a University of Queensland Right to Information and Privacy officer (rti@uq.edu.au). For further information regarding the management of your personal information, please refer to UQ's [Research Data Management Policy](#), [Privacy Management Policy](#) and [Privacy Management Procedure](#).

What will happen if I decide to withdraw?

Your participation is voluntary and you are free to withdraw at any time without giving an explanation. You can withdraw by telling the researcher during the session or by contacting the research team using the details at the top of this information sheet. There is no penalty for withdrawing.

If you withdraw, no additional data or information will be collected from you. Data already collected before withdrawal may be retained where necessary to preserve the integrity of the research record and to meet University requirements.

Where your evaluation data can still be linked to your participant code, you may request that it not be used in the analysis. Once data have been fully de-identified and combined with other participants' results, it may no longer be possible to identify and remove your individual data.

Can I hear about the results of this research?

A brief summary of the study findings can be requested from the research team after the evaluation has been completed. Results may also appear in university coursework, reports, presentations, or demonstrations in de-identified form.

Who can I contact if I have any concerns about the project?

Questions about the nature of this project and participation in it should be directed to the research team (see top of information sheet for details).

This study will be conducted in accordance with the principles of the National Statement on Ethical Conduct in Human Research and applicable University of Queensland review requirements. Recruitment should not begin until the required ethics or course-level approval has been confirmed. You are free to discuss concerns regarding this study or your participation with the research team. If, after approval, you would like to speak to an officer of the University not involved in the study, you may contact the Human Research Ethics Team via email humanethics@research.uq.edu.au or the contact details provided by UQ Research Support. <https://research-support.uq.edu.au/research-support/ethics-integrity-compliance/contacts>

Participant name (please print):

Tiandi Yang

Date:

Sep 10, 2020

Participant signature:

Tiandi Yang